

• Medium • #3 • Longest Substring Without Repeating Characters

▲ **Problem Statement** • Given a string, find the length of the longest substring without repeating characters.

▲ **Main Solution** • Use an array to store the last index where each character appeared. If a character appears again inside the current substring, move "left" directly after its previous position.

▲ **Brute Force** • Check every possible substring & find the longest one without duplicate characters.

▲ **Algorithm** • 1] Create an array "last [256]" & fill it with "-1".

2] Set "left = 0" & "maxLength = 0".

3] Loop through the string using "right".

4] If the current character was seen inside the current window, move:-

"left = last[c] + 1;"

5] Update the character's last position.

6] Update "maxLength".

7] Return "maxLength".

▲ **Important Points** • "last [256]" stores the last position of each character.

• "-1" means the character has not appeared yet.

- If a duplicate is inside the current window; jump "left" forward.

- Window length: "right - left + 1"

▲ Complexity → Brute Force → $O(n^2)$ & $O(n)$
 Optimized → $O(n)$ & $O(1)$

- Medium → #5 → Longest Palindromic Substring

▲ Problem Statement → Given